

Term paper grading rubric

Category	Exceeds expectations (9–10)	Meets expectations (7–8)	Nearly meets expectations (5–6)	Does not meet expectations (3–4)	Incomplete (0–1)
Required elements present?	All required elements are present.	One required element is missing.	Two required elements are missing.	Several required elements are missing.	
Introduction	The introduction successfully “funnels” by providing a broad context and narrowing in to the purpose of the paper.	The introduction provides appropriate background context but does not “funnel”.	The introduction states the main topic but does not provide appropriate background context.	There is no clear introduction or main topic and no background context.	Absent
Research question/ hypothesis	Research question and predicted results are stated, the explanation is clear and accurate based on what has been studied.	Research question and predicted results are stated, but the explanation is unclear or not quite logical.	Research question and predicted results are stated, but not explained.	No research question or predicted results stated.	Absent
Methods	Methods are reported clearly, accurately, and in logical order.	Methods are reported mostly accurately and somewhat clearly, but may lack logical order or are difficult to follow.	Methods are reported but do not accurately represent the steps of the study or are missing important pieces.	Methods are missing.	n/a
Results	Concise, clear, and accurate statement of results.	Accurate statement of results.	Statement of results included.	No results included.	n/a
Graphs	Clear, accurate graphs illustrate the results well and are labeled neatly and accurately.	Clear, accurate graphs are included and labeled.	Graphs are included and are labeled but may be missing important labels or have some inaccuracies.	Graphs are missing or mostly inaccurate.	n/a
Discussion	Writer demonstrates logical and subtle sequencing of ideas through well-developed paragraphs; transitions are used to enhance organization.	Paragraph development present but not perfected.	Logical organization; organization of ideas not fully developed.	No evidence of structure or organization.	n/a
Conclusion	The conclusion is engaging and explains the outcome of the reported test of the research question.	The conclusion explains the outcome of the reported test of the research question.	The conclusion does not adequately explain the outcome of the reported test of the research question.	Incomplete and/or unfocused.	Absent
Mechanics	No errors in punctuation, capitalization, spelling, sentence structure, or word usage.	Almost no errors in punctuation, capitalization, spelling, sentence structure, or word usage.	Many errors in punctuation, capitalization, spelling, sentence structure, or word usage.	Numerous and distracting errors in punctuation, capitalization, spelling, sentence structure, or word usage.	n/a
References	All references are cited in the correct format with no errors. All sources are legitimate.	Some references are cited in the correct format. All sources are legitimate.	Few references are cited in the correct format. Some illegitimate sources (e.g., websites).	No references are cited in the correct format. Reference list contains illegitimate sources.	Absent